Khaliquzzaman M. Macabato

Atty. Khaliquzzaman M. Macabato, CPA, CSEE, is a Filipino public health administrator, legal educator, and certified public accountant who served for over two decades as the PhilHealth Regional Vice President for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM), previously the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM).

He is one of the few Bangsamoro professionals in the country to hold triple qualifications as a lawyer, a Certified Public Accountant (CPA), and a Career Service Executive Eligible (CSEE), a combination that gave him a rare institutional edge in navigating the complex intersection of public health governance, fiscal management, and legal administration.

His career tells a story about what sustained public service can look like in a region that has long been defined by conflict, underrepresentation, and unmet need. For more than two decades, he worked to extend the reach of social health insurance to some of the most remote, conflict-affected communities in the Philippines, while simultaneously mentoring a generation of Bangsamoro lawyers and accountants at the Mindanao State University (MSU) College of Law in Iligan City.

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Early Life and Background

Khaliquzzaman Macabato traces his roots to Mindanao, with strong communal ties to Marawi City and the surrounding provinces that now form the BARMM.

His name itself carries meaning: "Khaliquzzaman" combines *Al-Khaliq* (the Creator, one of the 99 Names of Allah in Islamic tradition) with *zaman* (Arabic for era or time), a name that speaks to the faith-rooted culture of the Bangsamoro people.

Like many Muslim Mindanao professionals of his generation, Macabato came of age in a region where access to quality education and government service was not a given. The region's history of armed conflict, political neglect, and economic marginalization made it all the more significant when young Bangsamoro men and women chose the path of professional public service.

Specific biographical details of his birth and early childhood are not on public record.

Education and Professional Qualifications

Atty. Macabato built his academic and professional credentials across multiple disciplines, which would define the unusual range of his public service career.

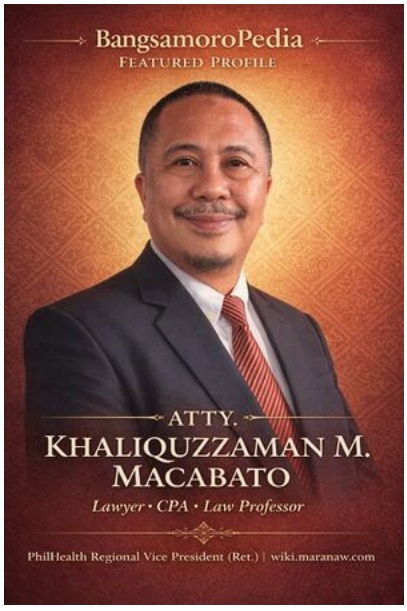
He earned qualifications as a **Certified Public Accountant (CPA)** and as an **Attorney-at-Law**, two demanding and distinct professional examinations in the Philippines that together position him in a small, specialized category of legal-accounting practitioners.

He also holds the distinction of being a **Career Service Executive Eligible (CSEE)**, the highest civil service eligibility in the Philippines for senior government executives, qualifying him for Career Executive Service positions in the bureaucracy.

For advanced professional development in his area of public health practice, Macabato completed the prestigious **Flagship Course on Sustainable Social Health Insurance** at the Asian Institute of Management (AIM) in Makati City.

This combination of legal training, accounting expertise, and executive civil service eligibility is what made him particularly effective in a role that demanded both technical compliance management and high-stakes policy leadership.

Atty. Khaliquzzaman M. Macabato



Qualifications	Attorney-at-Law, CPA, CSEE
Region Served	BARMM (formerly ARMM)
Employer (Primary)	PhilHealth
Position	Regional Vice President, PhilHealth BARMM
Tenure at PhilHealth	December 2002 – 2025
Teaching Position	Professorial Lecturer in Taxation Law, MSU-IIT
Teaching Tenure	May 2001 – present
Education	Asian Institute of Management (Flagship Course, Social Health Insurance)
Religion	Islam
Nationality	Filipino

Career

Early Career: Accounting at MSU-General Santos City (1988–1994)

Macabato began his professional life in the public sector as an **Accountant** at Mindanao State University (MSU) in General Santos City, where he served from 1988 to 1994.

This early post grounded him in the fundamentals of government financial management and gave him hands-on experience with the fiscal demands of a public university serving a diverse, largely underserved student population.

Legal Education: MSU College of Law (2001–Present)

In May 2001, Macabato took on a parallel role that would run alongside his executive career for decades: he joined the faculty of the **Mindanao State University - Iligan Institute of Technology** (MSU-IIT) College of Law in Iligan City as a **Professorial Lecturer**, specializing in **Taxation Law**.

His lectures have covered core areas of Philippine fiscal law, including the National Internal Revenue Code, income tax, Value Added Tax (VAT), estate taxes, and the provisions of the TRAIN Law (Tax Reform for Acceleration and Inclusion).

What makes his approach distinctive is what his students describe as the "CPA-lawyer perspective," the ability to bridge the mathematical and computational rigor of accounting with the doctrinal and interpretive demands of legal practice.

He's known for clarifying foundational concepts like the Lifeblood Doctrine of taxation (the principle that taxes are the lifeblood of the government and their prompt collection a paramount duty) in ways that connect legal theory to real government operations.

Beyond taxation, his portfolio at MSU College of Law has included **Commercial Law** and **Corporate Governance**, drawing from his executive experience at PhilHealth to contextualize how large government-owned and controlled corporations (GOCCs) operate under the law.

Several of his lectures have been made available online through video platforms, extending his reach beyond the classroom to aspiring bar reviewees and practicing lawyers across the country.<ref name="msu-youtube">Atty. Khaliquzzaman Macabato. Taxation Law lectures. Available at: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9QnrduN1yVg and https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RMxHXJGWNeQ</ref>

PhilHealth ARMM/BARMM: Regional Vice President (2002–2025)

In December 2002, Macabato joined the Philippine Health Insurance Corporation (PhilHealth) and was assigned to the **PhilHealth Regional Office – ARMM** (which later became the PhilHealth Regional Office – BARMM following the ratification of the Bangsamoro Organic Law in 2019).

He would remain in this position for over two decades, becoming the longest-serving regional executive in the history of PhilHealth's operations in the Bangsamoro region.

As **Regional Vice President (RVP)**, he held authority over the implementation of the National Health Insurance Program (NHIP) across the provinces and component cities under the region, a mandate that required him to navigate conditions no other PhilHealth regional executive faced in quite the same way: areas affected by active armed conflict, fragmented local governance structures, and communities with among the lowest health literacy and PhilHealth membership rates in the entire country.

> "It is truly a privilege for us at PhilHealth Regional Office ARMM to have presented the concrete testimony of how the government has helped change lives through the PAMANA project. Bringing social health protection to the most far-flung areas in the country, including conflict-affected and conflict-vulnerable communities, is another milestone towards realizing PhilHealth's vision of making *bawat Pilipino miyembro, bawat miyembro protektado, kalusugan natin, segurado.*"

This quote, delivered by Macabato at the 2nd PhilHealth Forward in 2015, reflects the mission that anchored his tenure: making universal health care a reality even in communities that most of the country had overlooked.<ref name="philhealth-2015">PhilHealth. "2nd PhilHealth Forward for 2015 Held." Philippine Health Insurance

Corporation. December 23, 2015. https://www.philhealth.gov.ph/news/2015/2nd_forward.html</ref>

Governance and Procurement Leadership

During his tenure, Macabato led significant modernization efforts within the regional office.

He approved procurement contracts for the upgrading of information technology infrastructure, including desktop computers, laptops, and flatbed scanners, to digitize member records and improve claims processing in remote Bangsamoro areas.<ref name="philhealth-procurement">PhilHealth Regional Office ARMM. Notices to Proceed, IT Resources and Flatbed Scanners. 2015. https://www.philhealth.gov.ph/about_us/bidsNprojects/2015/Regional/PROARMM/</ref>

His legal background made him particularly adept at ensuring regional operations complied with the **Republic Act 9184** (Government Procurement Reform Act) and its Revised Implementing Rules and Regulations. He oversaw multiple Annual Procurement Plan (APP) amendments, balancing the corporate operating budget with the unique demands of health service delivery in conflict-affected provinces.

He also oversaw the expansion of **Group Enrollment Programs** and the implementation of the **Konsulta Package**, which prioritized primary health consultations and preventive care for indigents and organized groups throughout the Bangsamoro region.

Board of Trustee: Philippine Integrated School, Marawi City (2001–Present)

Alongside his PhilHealth and MSU roles, Macabato has served since 2001 as a **Board of Trustee member** of the **Philippine Integrated School** in Marawi City, one of the key private educational institutions serving Bangsamoro youth in Lanao del Sur.

This role has kept him directly connected to the community-level realities of Bangsamoro education, long before his executive commitments required him to operate from regional capitals.

Contributions and Legacy

Advancing Social Health Insurance in the Bangsamoro Region

Macabato's most enduring contribution is the sustained institutional presence of PhilHealth in a region where government services have historically been erratic, incomplete, or absent altogether.

For over two decades, he built and maintained the operational infrastructure that allowed PhilHealth to function in the ARMM and then the BARMM, including during periods of intense armed conflict, the Battle of Marawi in 2017, and through the political transition from ARMM to BARMM in 2019.

He was a consistent advocate for the **PAMANA Program** (Payapa at Masaganang Pamayanan), a government initiative aimed at extending social services to conflict-affected and conflict-vulnerable communities, which PhilHealth participated in through health insurance coverage for residents in far-flung Bangsamoro areas.

Legal and Fiscal Literacy Advocacy

Beyond his executive role, Macabato has been a sustained voice for fiscal transparency and legal literacy in the Bangsamoro region.

He has consistently educated local government units (LGUs), private employers, and civil society organizations on the legal obligations and social importance of PhilHealth remittances, framing mandatory contributions not merely as regulatory compliance but as a social contract with Bangsamoro workers and families.

His outreach through MSU College of Law has contextualized national tax and commercial laws within the governance structure of the Bangsamoro Organic Law, helping future lawyers understand how RA 11054 reshapes the application of national statutes within autonomous Bangsamoro institutions.

The Rawaten Awards

During his years of leadership at PhilHealth BARMM, the regional office institutionalized the **Rawaten Awards** ("Rawaten" being the Maranao word for "model" or "to be emulated"), a recognition program honoring healthcare facilities and employers that demonstrate exceptional compliance with PhilHealth mandates and commitment to employee health security.

The awards program stands as part of Macabato's legacy of building a culture of accountability and recognition within the regional health insurance ecosystem.

Recognition and Departure

In **July 2025**, PhilHealth held a formal leadership turnover ceremony marking Macabato's transition after more than two decades at the helm of the regional office.

During the ceremony, PhilHealth leadership acknowledged that his tenure had been defined by a consistent push for **inclusive healthcare access** across the Bangsamoro provinces.

His colleagues credited him with being a stabilizing force in regional health operations, particularly during the turbulent political transition from ARMM to BARMM and during the post-conflict rehabilitation period following the Battle of Marawi in 2017.

Atty. Macarambon was named as Acting Regional Vice President, taking over the leadership of PhilHealth BARMM from Macabato.

Personal Values and Professional Philosophy

What stands out across Macabato's decades of service is a consistent philosophy: that professional expertise carries a social obligation, especially in a region as historically underserved as the Bangsamoro.

His simultaneous maintenance of three distinct professional roles, as a regional health executive, a law professor, and a school trustee, reflects a belief that leadership in the Bangsamoro context means showing up in multiple arenas at once.

His integration of legal rigour and accounting precision within public health administration helped him translate complex national policy into operational realities on the ground in Maguindanao, Lanao del Sur, Basilan, Sulu, and Tawi-Tawi.

His students at MSU College of Law have noted his ability to make taxation law human and relevant, connecting abstract fiscal doctrine to the lived realities of government service and business practice in Muslim Mindanao.

See Also

- Philippine Health Insurance Corporation
- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Mindanao State University – Iligan Institute of Technology
- Bangsamoro Organic Law
- National Health Insurance Program
- PAMANA Program
- Marawi City
- Maranao people

References

Further Reading

- PhilHealth. "2nd PhilHealth Forward for 2015 Held." Philippine Health Insurance Corporation Official Website. December 2015.
- Atty. Khaliquzzaman Macabato. Taxation Law Lectures. MSU College of Law. Available on YouTube.

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